

Flower Dedication

The flowers adorning the sanctuary this morning are given to the glory of God,
who is rich in mercy and abounding in steadfast love.
— *Stephen & Linda Holley*

Announcements

The Red Rose welcomes Thomas Charles Childers, born September 22, 2026, to Sara & Tucker Childers.

With Sympathy. Our sympathy goes out to Laura Giaccaglini and her family at the loss of her mother, Karen Silvestri, on September 11.

Roca Blanca Mission Trip. Please be in prayer for our mission team as they travel and work at the Roca Blanca Missions base this week.

Samaritan’s Purse Shoeboxes. Collection boxes are available in the children’s wing and the side entrance by the church office. You can participate by shopping and collecting items, or by donating monetarily — each shoebox costs \$10 to ship. Items needed: small composition notebooks, pencils, small cars/trucks, puzzles, jump ropes, hair bows/barrettes/brushes/combs, underwear in larger sizes, and small stuffed animals. No liquids, candy, or food!

Those Who Serve Today

Assisting Elder — Brett Butler

Greeters — John & Virginia Boyd James

Acolytes — Cecil Sexton & Hadley Howell

Circle of Prayer — Dr. Stephen Blair, Cindy Blair, & Dave Shanklin

AV Engineer — Russell Smith

Ushers — Dave Shanklin, Peter Fisher, Cameron Crockett, JR Burns, & Nick Ashmore

Nursery — Deborah Kiddy, Sarah Bynum, Jennifer Sexton, Deb Parker, Laura Giaccaglini, & Mary Elizabeth Pounders

Church Staff

Rev. Waring Porter - Pastor

Gregg Parker - Dir. of Discipleship

Bobby Capps - Dir. of Outreach & Care

Jennifer Shipp - Dir. of Student Ministries

Laura Kate Carmichiel - Dir. of Women’s Min. & Comm.

Phyllis Sellers - Day School Director

Jan Pike - Choir Director

Malechi Doren - Accompanist

Teresa Tsagarakis - Administrative Assistant

Sammy Allred - Bookkeeper

The Church Calendar

Sept. 26 – Oct. 3 Roca Blanca Mission Trip

Sept. 29 – Oct. 2 LeConte Pilgrimage

October 4 Session Meeting

October 7 Outdoor Movie Night: *Mary Poppins*, 6:30 p.m.

October 11 Deacons’ Meeting

Online Giving



Scan to give online



FIRST PRESBYTERIAN
CHURCH

September 27, 2026

Eighteenth Sunday after Pentecost

“To be disciples, to make disciples”

Welcome

We Are Glad You Are Here!

We are honored that you decided to join us this morning. Whether it is your first time in church, your first time in a long while, or part of your regular rhythm, we hope you will be encouraged by the fellowship with each other, and with our Lord, as we worship him together.

If this is your first time with us, please take a moment and fill out a Next Steps Card found on the back of the pew, or scan the QR code and submit it on your phone. We would love to meet you and help you get connected.

Children & Nursery

There is no Children’s Church this week during the school break, but members of our congregation will lead “A Word for the Children” during the service. Children are always welcome in worship! Children’s bulletins and crayons are available in the Narthex and at the East entrance.

Nursery rooms for infants through age 3 are in the Education Wing, with the entrance behind the playground on the west side of campus. If you have a newborn and/or are nursing your baby, please feel free to use our baby room just off the narthex — a quiet space with comfortable seating where the worship service is broadcast as well.

Our Vision & Mission

Our vision is to see lives transformed by the power of the gospel, rooted in God’s Word and the Reformed tradition, in order to create a culture of discipleship at FPC where disciples WORSHIP holistically, GROW relationally in Christ, and SERVE boldly in the world for the glory of God. Our mission is to accomplish this by “Being Disciples and Making Disciples.”

Connect With Us

Website: fpccorinth.org
Phone: 662-286-6638
Address: 919 East Shiloh Rd, Corinth, MS 38834

Sermon Outline

“Restored by Grace: Clinging to God’s Mercy”

Rev. Waring Porter · Ezra 9:5–15

The biblical word for repentance means to turn — to change one’s mind and direction because we have come to recognize that we are going the wrong way. Biblical repentance is more than simply feeling bad about what we’ve done. It involves honestly acknowledging our sin before God, turning away from it, and turning back toward God in faith and obedience. That is important because there is a difference between regret and repentance.

True repentance doesn’t cause us to run away from God because our sin is so terrible. True repentance causes us to run toward God because His mercy is greater than our sin. Ezra knows that God’s grace is not permission to keep going in the same direction. God’s mercy changes us. It turns us around and enables us to follow Him faithfully.

TRUE REPENTANCE:

I. Sees Sin Honestly (vv. 5–7)

II. Remembers God’s Mercy (vv. 8–9)

III. Turns Toward Obedience (vv. 10–15)

Resources: Matthew Henry’s Commentary, Vol. 2, Matthew Henry; Ezra & Nehemiah, Derek Kidner; Ezra & Nehemiah, Jacob M. Myers; Westminster Confession of Faith

LITURGY FOR THE WORSHIP OF GOD

September 27, 2026

* Indicates congregation standing if able

GATHERING

Our worship is a covenant conversation between God and His people. Throughout the service, God graciously speaks to us through His Word, and we joyfully respond with praise, confession, prayer, faith, thanksgiving, and obedience.

The Piano Prelude

Greetings & Announcements

Call to Meditation: Micah 7:19

“He will again have compassion on us; he will tread our iniquities underfoot. You will cast all our sins into the depths of the sea.”

The Prelude

*Call to Worship: Psalm 130

Leader: Out of the depths I cry to you, O LORD!

All: O Lord, hear my voice! Let your ears be attentive to the voice of my pleas for mercy!

Leader: If you, O LORD, should mark iniquities, O Lord, who could stand?

All: But with you there is forgiveness, that you may be feared.

Leader: I wait for the LORD; my soul waits, and in his word I hope.

All: My soul waits for the Lord more than watchmen for the morning, more than watchmen for the morning.

Leader: O Israel, hope in the LORD!

All: For with the LORD there is steadfast love, and with him is plentiful redemption.

Leader: And he will redeem Israel from all his iniquities.

All: Let us worship the LORD, who is merciful and gracious, slow to anger and abounding in steadfast love.

*The Hymn: #76

“O For a Thousand Tongues to Sing” (vv. 1–3)

SENDING

*Hymn: #203

“And Can It Be?”

*Benediction

*Postlude

BENEDICTION

God’s people are blessed by the Lord and sent forth into the world, bearing with them the hope and peace of the Gospel. This should remind us that God doesn’t just meet with us when we gather, but He goes with us as we scatter. As we continue our worship, we do so as people sent to our community for reconciliation, bearing witness to the good news of the gospel.

PRELUDE

The prelude provides a quiet moment to prepare for worship. As the music begins, we are encouraged to calm our hearts, focus our minds, and enter reverently into God’s presence.

SINGING OF HYMNS

One distinctive feature of Christian worship is that we lift our voices together. Our singing expresses both our love for God and our delight in the good news of the gospel. When we sing songs that are rich in truth and accessible to all, our attention is lifted from the wonder of creation to the greater wonder of the Creator. Scripture calls us to sing praises, and while musical skill is not required, hearts united in truth and offered with sincerity and joy are pleasing to God.

INVOCATION
The word “invocation” suggests that the congregation calls upon God, yet this must not be misunderstood to mean that we bring God into our presence or that His nearness depends on our request. The Lord is already present with His people before our worship begins. To “invoke” is to call upon or earnestly seek. So, we lift our voices to God, asking Him to draw near and enable us to worship Him rightly for His character and mighty works.

*Prayer of Invocation & The Lord’s Prayer

Our Father, who art in heaven, hallowed be thy Name. Thy Kingdom come, thy will be done on earth, as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread, and forgive us our debts, as we forgive our debtors. Lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil. For thine is the kingdom, the power, and the glory, forever. Amen.

*The Psalter Reading: Psalm 32:1–6, 10–11

Leader: Blessed is the one whose transgression is forgiven, whose sin is covered. Blessed is the man against whom the Lord counts no iniquity, and in whose spirit there is no deceit.

All: For when I kept silent, my bones wasted away through my groaning all day long. For day and night your hand was heavy upon me; my strength was dried up as by the heat of summer. I acknowledged my sin to you, and I did not cover my iniquity;

Leader: I said, “I will confess my transgressions to the Lord,” and you forgave the iniquity of my sin. Therefore let everyone who is godly offer prayer to you at a time when you may be found; surely in the rush of great waters, they shall not reach him.

All: Many are the sorrows of the wicked, but steadfast love surrounds the one who trusts in the Lord.

Leader: Be glad in the Lord, and rejoice, O righteous, and shout for joy, all you upright in heart!

*Hymn of Response: #76 “O For a Thousand Tongues to Sing” (vv. 4–5)

Corporate Prayer of Confession

Gracious and holy God, we confess that our sins are many, and that we have often wandered from Your ways. We have received Your abundant mercy, yet we have been unfaithful to You. We have followed the desires of our own hearts rather than Your Word and have failed to live as Your holy people. O Lord, we are ashamed and humbled before You. We do not presume upon Your grace, nor do we claim righteousness of our own. Yet You, O God, have been gracious to us and have not dealt with us according to our sins. Forgive us for the sake of Jesus Christ, who bore our guilt and secured our reconciliation with You. Turn our hearts again to You, and by Your Spirit enable us to walk faithfully in obedience and gratitude. We confess our sins and rest in Your mercy.

Silent Confession

*Assurance of Divine Pardon: 1 John 1:9

“If we confess our sins, he is faithful and just to forgive us our sins and to cleanse us from all unrighteousness.”

*Gloria Patri

Glory be to the Father, and to the Son: and to the Holy Ghost; As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be: world without end. Amen.

Sacrament of Infant Baptism

*Lily Seabrook Whitaker
Daughter of Tanner & Annalee Whitaker*

*Song of Blessing: “Jesus Loves You”

Jesus loves you, this we know, for the Bible tells us so; Little ones to Him belong, you are weak but He is strong. Yes, Jesus loves you! Yes, Jesus loves you! Yes, Jesus loves you! The Bible tells us so.

ASSURANCE OF PARDON
After confessing our sins, we hear God’s promise of forgiveness, reminding us that the good news of Jesus Christ meets our confession with grace. We are reminded that true repentance is always answered by God’s faithful forgiveness, and Christ’s saving work is greater than our sin.

INFANT BAPTISM
We believe infant baptism is a sign and seal of God’s covenant of grace, marking the children of believers as members of the visible church just as circumcision did under the old covenant. It does not guarantee salvation, but it signifies God’s promises and calls the child to personal faith and repentance as they grow. (Gen. 17:7–12; Col. 2:11–12)

WORD

The Giving of Tithes and Offerings

The Offertory

*The Doxology and Prayer of Dedication

Praise God, from whom all blessings flow; Praise Him, all creatures here below; Praise Him above, ye heavenly host; Praise Father, Son, and Holy Ghost. Amen.